17. **Ans: C**

The electric force on the positive charge is pointing in the direction of the E-field. So the external force exerted to move the charge is pointing in the opposite direction to the E-field.

Work done by external force, $W = F\,s\cos\theta = qEs\cos 0^\circ$
$= (2.6 \times 10^{-8})(3.0 \times 10^{5})(4.0 \times 10^{-3})$
$= +\,3.1 \times 10^{-5}$ J

18. **Ans: A**